CHAPTER 01 | AROUND 2000-2007, WITH EARLIER MEMORIES CLEARLY IDENTIFIED

Fiango

Football, friendship, unpaid school fees, and a gifted boy's growing determination to give his mother a better life.

Dramatic question What happens when a boy who can invent a solution to anything meets a problem he cannot talk his way out of?

Act I - Setup

Street football introduces Zino's wit, competitiveness, and temper. Luc and Gideon hear his outrageous stories about Grand-Chukuchuku, the man who achieves what nobody else can. Brief fantasy sequences make those boasts visible before returning us to the real game. The compound is a small society: two families, three single mothers, two bachelors, and three student tenants share the well and mango tree. The landlord's monthly collection of rent and electricity money turns money into a recurring presence. Zino's mother, a primary-school teacher, believes in him. His father died after a snake bite while spraying cocoa when Zino was two, so the loss enters through family history rather than a memory he owns.

Turning point: His imagination can win an argument, but the household's limits cannot be wished away.

Act II - Confrontation

Education reveals both Zino's ability and the limits of that advantage. His earlier primary-school fee exclusion can return as a clearly placed memory; the later high-school exclusion belongs at its actual date. His mother's primary-school teaching income and his uncle's intermittent help keep opportunity alive without removing uncertainty. Boarding school in Kumba supplies comic escapes over the fence to eat at home. Each June, the daytime vocational school called Professional School opens classrooms at night for secondary-school students to revise, study in groups, socialize, or escape home; show its temptations without claiming every student is distracted. Zino's four reported encounters with jungle justice occur in these years. Feature them through a composite episode about fear and aftermath, not graphic spectacle.

Turning point: Being the cleverest boy in the room does not guarantee that he can remain in it.

Act III - Consequence

Zino completes secondary school in 2007. Academic progress creates a new threshold rather than financial security. The closing movement should grow from a remembered examination, result, or family conversation, making clear what this achievement means to him and his mother. Grand-Chukuchuku can still supply effortless victories; Zino's real future requires help, patience, and choices. The child who dreams of lifting his mother out of hardship now faces the practical requirements of further education. The chapter ends with a milestone achieved and the next opportunity still uncertain.

Turning point: He has the ability to continue, but the household still needs a way to pay.

CHAPTER 01 | DEVELOPMENT PAGE

Make this chapter yours

Fiango

At the beginning	At ten, Zino has completed primary school and lives with his mother in Fiango.
At the end	Secondary school is complete in 2007; his ambition now depends on finding a way to continue.

Three possible short episodes

1. Grand-Chukuchuku Never Loses

A football dispute introduces the imaginary hero and the real boy's difficulty accepting an unfavorable decision.

2. School Fees

At the remembered age, a fee exclusion interrupts academic confidence and changes the rhythm of an ordinary school day.

3. Professional School

June evening revision creates a divided space: some students study; some pursue distraction; Zino must decide what kind of future he is preparing for.

4. The Crowd

After Zino witnesses the aftermath of an alleged thief being attacked, the episode stays with his fear, the adults' silence, and the question of justice rather than depicting the killing.

Memory prompts

1. Which secondary school did you enter, when did boarding begin, and what is one defining memory of Luc, Gideon, Elianne, or Miss Mukete?

2. Who told you the story of your father's death, and what details are most important for that family-history scene?

3. What did Professional School mean in your school, which exam was it for, and what is one evening you remember?

4. For each jungle-justice incident, what did you witness directly, how old were you, and what effect did it have on you?

Grand-Chukuchuku motif Grand-Chukuchuku is playful and spectacular: imaginary victories contrast with ordinary limits.

Details still open: The opening is at ten, after primary completion in 1999. The age-ten fee scene remains a proposed composite. Zino's father died when he was two, so he has no firsthand memory of it. Professional School is a vocational campus that opens classrooms at night during the secondary-school exam period.